PROJECT FOR EXCELLENCE IN JOURNALISM
NEWS COVERAGE INDEX CODEBOOK

In this codebook you will find information on variables included in the 2008 PEJ News Coverage Index (NCI) dataset made available through our website. This codebook includes variable names, definitions and applicable procedures, specifics on changes that were made to certain variables such as when certain variables were added and subtracted from the coding scheme. The complete methodology of the weekly NCI can be found at http://www.journalism.org/about_news_index/methodology.

The list of variables included is as follows: story date, story ID, source, broadcast start time, duration in seconds, headline, story word count, placement/ prominence, story format, big story, sub-storyline, geographic focus, broad story topic, lead newsmaker, and media sector.

VARIABLES

STORY DATE:

- **Definition**:
  This variable designates the date on which the news story was published, broadcast, or posted.
- **Procedure**:
  Express year, then month, and then date (year/month/date).
- **Example**: January 12, 2004= 20040112

STORY ID:

- **Definition**:
  This variable provides a unique ID number for each news story.
- **Procedure**:
  The number will automatically be assigned to each story by the Database program.

SOURCE:

- **Definition**:
  Designates the outlet (and program for broadcast media) in which the individual news story appeared.

Codes

Newspapers

New York Times	001

Washington Post	002
Wall Street Journal	003
USA Today	004
Chicago Tribune (3/31/08-12/31/08)	005
Boston Globe (1/01/08- 3/30/08)	006
Star Tribune (MN) (1/01/08- 3/30/08)	007
MetroWest Daily News (3/10/08-12/31/08)	008
Star Beacon (OH) (1/01/08- 2/29/08)	009
Austin American-Statesman (1/01/08- 3/30/08)	010
Bakersfield Californian (1/01/08- 3/30/08)	011
Sun Chronicle (MA) (1/01/08- 3/30/08)	012
Los Angeles Times	013
Albuquerque Journal (1/01/08- 3/30/08)	014
Chattanooga Times Free Press (1/01/08- 3/30/08)	015
New Hampshire Union Leader (3/31/08-12/31/08)	020
Philadelphia Inquirer (3/31/08-12/31/08)	030
Arkansas Democrat-Gazette (3/31/08-12/31/08)	031
San Francisco Chronicle (3/31/08-12/31/08)	032
The Gazette (Colorado Springs) (3/31/08-12/31/08)	033
Modesto Bee (3/31/08-12/31/08)	034

Online

CNN.com (9 am capture)	200
CNN.com (4 pm capture) (added 4/28/08)	210
Yahoo News (9 am capture)	201
Yahoo News (4 pm capture)(added 4/28/08)	211
MSNBC.com (9 am capture)	202
MSNBC.com (4 pm capture) (added 4/28/08)	212
Google News (9 am capture)	204
Google News (4 pm capture) (added 4/28/08)	214
AOL News (9 am capture)	206
AOL News (4 pm capture) (added 4/28/08)	216

Television

ABC	
Good Morning America	401
World News Tonight	402
NBC	
Today	421
NBC Nightly News	422
CBS	
The Early Show	441
CBS Evening News	442

PBS

Newshour with Jim Lehrer – 1st 30 minutes	461
Newshour with Jim Lehrer – 2nd 30 minutes (added 4/1/08)	462

CNN

CNN unspecified show	500
CNN Daytime	501
Situation Room	502
Anderson Cooper 360	504
Lou Dobbs Tonight	506
Out in the Open (1/1/08- 1/13/08)	507
CNN Election Center (1/14/08- 10/24/08)	508
Campbell Brown: No Bias, No Bull (10/27/08- 12/31/08)	509

MSNBC

MSNBC unspecified show	520
MSNBC Daytime	521
Hardball	522
Countdown with Keith Olbermann	523
Tucker (1/1/-08- 3/14/08)	524
Live with Dan Abrams (1/1/08- 8/21/08)	526
Race for the White House (3/17/08 – 11/05/08)	527
Rachel Maddow Show (9/8/08-12/31/08)	528
1600 Pennsylvania Avenue (11/06/08- 12/31/08)	529

Fox News

Fox News unspecified show	540
Fox News Daytime	541
Special Report with Britt Hume	542
O'Reilly Factor	543
Hannity and Colmes	544
Fox Report with Shepard Smith	545

Radio

NPR

Morning Edition	801

Other Radio

Rush Limbaugh	821
Ed Schultz	822
Randi Rhodes	823
Sean Hannity	824
Michael Savage	825

ABC News Headlines	827
CBS News Headlines	828

Note: Unspecified for any source means when any time there is a change in normal programming, we code the replacement show and label the show as unspecified.

BROADCAST START TIME:

- **Definition**: This variable applies to radio and TV broadcast news and gives the STARTING TIME of the program in which the story appears.

Codes

Morning program (5 a.m. – noon)	=	1
Noon program (noon – 2 p.m.)	=	2
Afternoon program (2 – 5 p.m.)	=	3
Evening program (5 – 8 p.m.)	=	4
Night program (8 – 11 p.m.)	=	5
Late Night Program (11 PM on)	=	6
Not broadcast	=	999999999

DURATION IN SECONDS:

- **Definition**: It is the amount of time in seconds for a broadcast story only, calculated by subtracting story start time from story end time.

HEADLINE:

- **Definition**: For radio and TV broadcasts only, this variable determines whether the story is part of a regular news round-up segment – often appearing at the beginning of an hour or half-hour broadcast show.

Codes

Not a headline/round-up story	=	0
Is a headline/round-up story	=	1
Print N/A (newspapers and online)	=	999999999

STORY WORD COUNT:

- **Definition**: Designates the word count of each individual print and online news story.

- **Procedure**: Enter the exact word count as reported by the database from which a story is pulled. If not provided, cut and paste story into Word document and run "word count" tool. Do NOT count headlines, sub-heads, datelines, bylines, or photo captions.

  If story is broadcast, code is 999999999.

PLACEMENT/ PROMINENCE:

- **Definition**: Designates where stories are located within a publication, on a website, or within a broadcast. The location reflects the prominence given the stories by the journalists creating and editing the content.

- **Placement for Newspapers**

Procedure: Prominence of lead story is determined by starting on the top-right corner of the front page, moving to the left corner, then moving down the left side of the front page. The location of prominence on the front page of a newspaper resembles an "S" shape pattern. A story that appears below the fold regardless of prominence is coded as 105.

Newspaper Codes

Front Page/Most Prominent	= 101
Front Page/2nd Prominent	= 102
Front Page/3rd Prominent (only if above the fold)	= 103
Front Page/Other – above the fold	= 104
Front Page/Other – below the fold	= 105
Front Page/DK/Can't Tell	= 120
Don't Know/Can't Tell	= 199

- **Placement for News Web Sites**

Procedure: Only code stories with significant headlines. We are also only coding stories made up of narrative text. We are not coding videos, audio clips, etc. at this time. The biggest headline at the top of the screen is the most important story. The second most prominent story is a story that is attached to an image at the top of the screen, if that is a

different story from the most prominent story. If there is no image at the top of the screen, (or there are two significant stories attached to the same image) refer then to the next largest headline. To determine the next prominent stories, refer to the size of the headlines, and the place (height) on the screen. If two stories have the exact same font size and are located at the exact same height on screen, then the story on the left has more prominence.

News Web Site Codes

Home Page/Most Prominent	= 201
Home Page/2nd Prominent	= 202
Home Page/3rd Prominent	= 203
Home Page/4th or lower Prominence	= 204
Home Page/DK/Can't Tell	= 220
Don't Know/Can't Tell	= 299

- **Placement for Broadcast**

Procedure: Decide what order in the broadcast the story appeared.

Broadcast Codes

Pre-story banter (anchor discussion prior to any news piece, such as when Jon Stewart introduces the Daily Show)	= 400
1st story	= 401
2nd story	= 402
3rd story	= 403
4th story	= 404
5th story or later	= 405
Don't Know/Can't Tell	= 499

STORY FORMAT

- **Definition** Measures the type and origin of stories. It designates, at a basic level, whether the news story is a product of original reporting, or drawn from another news source. It delineates stories within the publication or broadcast, while measuring the stories' type and origin.

Print and Online News Web Sites

Procedure: First determine if the story is a straight news story, a news analysis (which will always be labeled as "Analysis"), or an opinion column. A straight news story is an accounting of events without significant opinions expressed by the author of the article. A news analysis story must be explicitly labeled as "News Analysis" or "commentary" or something equivalent. And an opinion piece is an editorial, op-ed, or other piece expressing the author's opinion (like a music review).

Then determine the authorship of the story. Look at both the byline at the top of the story, and any credit lines that are included at the bottom of the story to determine authorship.

Print and Online News Web Site Codes

Straight news stories:

Internal staff report w/ byline	= 01
Internal staff report, no byline	= 02
Wire Story (non-parent company, such as AP or Reuters)	= 03
Combo Staff/Wire News Story (non-parent wire)	= 04
Parent Company (wire story or other)	= 05
Other News Outlet	= 06
Outside contributer/Freelancer	= 07
Combo staff/Parent Co. Wire Story	= 08

Articles noted as news analysis:

Internal staff report w/ byline	= 11
Internal staff report, no byline	= 12
Wire Story (non-parent company, such as AP or Reuters)	= 13
Combo Staff/Wire News Story (non-parent wire)	= 14
Parent Company (wire story or other)	= 15
Other News Outlet	= 16
Outside contributer/Freelancer	= 17
Combo staff/Parent Co. Wire Story	= 18

Opinion columns:

Internal staff report w/ byline	= 21
Internal staff report, no byline	= 22
Wire Story (non-parent company, such as AP or Reuters)	= 23
Combo Staff/Wire News Story (non-parent wire)	= 24
Parent Company (wire story or other)	= 25
Other News Outlet	= 26
Outside contributer/Freelancer	= 27
Combo staff/Parent Co. Wire Story	= 28

Non-staff/Non-wire reporting or authorship	= 38

No source/Can't tell = 39

Broadcast TV and RADIO

Broadcast TV and Radio Codes:

Standard Package/with editing: Designates a story that has been mostly prerecorded, although some packages can include a live segment by the reporter. It must feature video (for TV) and a source and/or REPORTER speaking. Anchor voiceovers setting up packages should be counted as part of package. An edited montage of soundbites, though rare, would be a package. = 51

Anchor Package/with editing: Designates a story that has been mostly prerecorded, although some packages can include a live segment by the ANCHOR (instead of a reporter). It must feature video (for TV) and a source and/or anchor speaking. Anchor voiceovers setting up packages should be counted as part of package. = 52

Interview with External Source: Interviews conducted with a source that is not part of the newsroom staff or not explicitly identified as being affiliated with the organization as a consultant or analyst (i.e., CNN analyst or consultant) on the newsroom payroll. The interview could be live or live-to-tape but must be or appear to be unedited – video overlays without audio during the interview does NOT make the segment an edited package. Also, a segment may have introductory video clips as part of the interview set-up - consider these part of the interview story. = 53

Interview with Staff or In-House Analyst: Interview with a source who is part of the newsroom staff or explicitly identified as being affiliated with the organization as a consultant or analyst (i.e., CNN analyst or consultant). A segment may have introductory video clips as part of the interview set-up - consider these part of the interview story. The interview can take place in the studio or someplace else. = 54

If the interview includes experts on the payroll and not on the payroll, code on the basis of the majority of the interview time. (If the majority of the time is spent with a non-payroll experts, code 53.)

Staff Live: (This is also called a "Reporter Live"). Material from a journalist that does NOT include comments from other newsmakers. It is usually outside the studio but can be inside, though rare. It cannot be part of a package. It can be live or recorded earlier as a live shot.

Video overlays during a "Staff Live" report while the reporter is speaking do NOT make the report an edited piece. = 55

Externally Produced Package: This is similar to the package above, but the reports come from other news organizations and not the network or outlet being coded. Network outlets are other news organizations unless the reporter explicitly signs off as representing the outlet being coded.

Any segment that is made up solely of edited clips from other programs without an element produced by the internal news organization, would count as an externally produced package = 56

External Live: Live unedited material from another news outlet and is labeled as such = 57

Anchor Voice Over: Anchor Voice Over w/Video: Story reported by anchor with video to support. No reporter is involved. = 58

Tell Story/No Source: Anchor reader without video. Graphics and animations do NOT count as video. In the absence of a produced piece, graphic presentations of Stock Market figures are coded as "anchor-tell" stories even if there is no voiceover. = 59

Banter: Banter involves anchors, reporters, weather reporters or others talking among themselves rather than reporting about a topic. Anchors can banter with non-talent. Banter can include the back and forth among anchors and reporters about the news and is distinguished from an interview by its departure from a q-&-a format. Banter may contain factual information and/or opinion. = 60

Live event: This is an event (e.g., a press conference, press briefing or news event, photo-op) that is carried live = 61

Unedited audio or video: An unedited replay of a single event (press conference, briefing) that is not carried live, but rather by tape at a later time. Similar to a "live event," however is not carried live. An event that is only slightly edited, but shown in large portions (such as when the PBS Newshour shows large chunks of a press conference with only slight edits) is also coded here = 62

Traffic/weather: These segments are explicitly about typical daily weather and traffic conditions. = 63

DK/Can't Tell = 99

Talk Radio Only Codes:

For talk radio shows only, use the following codes if a segment does not fall into any of the above formats. (Call-in segments should be coded as 53.)

Host monologue/conversation with audio clips: Host (or hosts) delivers a monologue or has a discussion with someone in the studio such as the producer, but it is not conducting an interview. During the monologue or conversation, audio clips are played and the host comments on them. This is different than banter because the discussion is about a particular topic, rather than a discussion about themselves = 70

Host monologue/conversation w/o audio clips: Same as code 70 above, except there are no audio clips during the discussion, only the host and perhaps another person in the studio are heard. This is different than banter because the discussion is about a particular topic, rather than a discussion about themselves. = 71

BIG STORY

Definition: Big stories are particular topics that occurred often in news media during the time period under study. Important to note is that this list is constantly updated throughout the year.

Procedure: If 50% or more of a story is about one of these big stories, code appropriately. If a story contains mentions of more than one big story, code for the big story that is more prominently mentioned.

Codes for 2008:		**Date Added**
002	Immigration debate	1/01/08
003	Same-sex marriage debate	1/01/08
005	U.S. domestic terrorism and efforts to combat	1/01/08
008	CIA leak/Valarie Plame leak investigation	1/01/08
010	Enron scandal	1/01/08
011	U.S. economy	1/01/08
012	Duke University lacrosse scandal	1/01/08
013	Conflict in the Middle East between Israel and Lebanon	1/01/08
014	Conflict in the Middle East between Israelis and Palestinians	1/01/08
016	North Korea nuclear conflict	1/01/08
017	War in Afghanistan	1/01/08
018	Iran	1/01/08
019	Congressional political corruption scandals	1/01/08
020	NASA and Space Shuttle Discovery	1/01/08
021	Hurricane Katrina aftermath	1/01/08
022	Global warming	1/01/08

023	Supreme Court actions	1/01/08
024	Abortion controversy	1/01/08
025	Stem cell research controversy	1/01/08
026	General Middle East discussion	1/01/08
027	Steve Irwin, the crocodile hunter, dies	1/01/08
031	Mark Foley page scandal	1/01/08
035	Baseball steroids scandal	1/01/08
037	War on Terror general	1/01/08
042	Conflict in Sudan/Darfur	1/01/08
052	Madonna and child	1/01/08
059	Pastor Ted Haggard scandal	1/01/08
067	Presidential bids for 2008	1/01/08
070	New Democratic-lead Congress	1/01/08
078	O.J. Simpson	1/01/08
079	Video game consoles (Microsoft, Nintendo, etc.)	1/01/08
086	Russian spy Litvinenko poisoning/death	1/01/08
087	Holiday Season	1/01/08
089	NY Cops shoot unarmed man, Sean Bell	1/01/08
100	Iraq War - events on the ground	1/01/08
101	Iraq War – U.S. homefront	1/01/08
102	Iraq War - policy debate	1/01/08
167	Princess Diana – questions about death	1/01/08
175	Palestinian conflict – rival factions in Gaza	1/01/08
177	Libya sentences Bulgarian nurses to death	1/01/08
187	Somalia/Ethiopia conflict	1/01/08
195	Apple introduces iPhone	1/01/08
204	MLK holiday/remembrances	1/01/08
205	Golden Globe awards	1/01/08
207	Cuba	1/01/08
211	American Idol TV show	1/01/08
215	Oscar awards	1/01/08
221	Energy debate	1/01/08
222	Health care debate	1/01/08
224	Barbaro euthanized	1/01/08
233	2008 congressional campaigns	1/01/08
243	Anna Nicole Smith dies	1/01/08
244	Grammy awards	1/01/08
256	XM/Sirius satellite radio merger	1/01/08
260	Britney Spears	1/01/08
261	HPV cervical cancer vaccine	1/01/08
267	Talk show host wars for cable/radio news	1/01/08
270	Bus crash with baseball team in Atlanta	1/01/08
272	Dick Cheney's health	1/01/08
276	Fired U.S. attorney controversy	1/01/08
277	John Couey convicted of killing Jessica Lunsford	1/01/08
282	NCAA basketball tournament	1/01/08

283	Gas/oil prices	1/01/08
286	Gays in the military	1/01/08
289	Pet food/Chinese product recalls	1/01/08
293	Tony Snow's health	1/01/08
297	White House scandals	1/01/08
299	Heart disease research	1/01/08
300	German polar bear Knut	1/01/08
306	Taxes/Tax day	1/01/08
309	Don Imus's controversial comments	1/01/08
311	Masters golf tournament	1/01/08
316	VA Tech shootings	1/01/08
322	French elections	1/01/08
325	Kucinich impeachment effort	1/01/08
326	Military cover-up? Pat Tillman and Jessica Lynch	1/01/08
333	DC escort scandal	1/01/08
341	Rupert Murdoch bids for Dow Jones/WSJ	1/01/08
342	Tornadoes in Kansas on May 4	1/01/08
344	Israel internal politics	1/01/08
353	Pollution/emissions	1/01/08
355	Missing girl in Portugal	1/01/08
359	Lebanon violence	1/01/08
362	Body armor for U.S. troops	1/01/08
365	Memorial Day events/remembrances	1/01/08
372	Miss Universe/Miss USA	1/01/08
378	Hurricane season coming	1/01/08
379	NY Terrorist plot against JFK airport	1/01/08
381	G-8 Summit	1/01/08
396	Ohio missing pregnant woman	1/01/08
401	VP Cheney controversies	1/01/08
406	Fairness Doctrine	1/01/08
407	London bomb discovered, Glasgow attack	1/01/08
409	4th of July celebrations/holiday	1/01/08
412	Harry Potter	1/01/08
415	Hot dog eating contest	1/01/08
425	Catholic Priest abuse scandal	1/01/08
428	Michael Vick indicted	1/01/08
430	FDA and tainted imported food	1/01/08
433	Pakistan	1/01/08
436	NBA referee scandal	1/01/08
442	Alberto Gonzales scandals	1/01/08
450	Minneapolis bridge collapse	1/01/08
451	Ethics reform bill	1/01/08
452	Miners trapped after Salt Lake earthquake	1/01/08
453	2008 Olympics in Beijing	1/01/08
460	Space shuttle Endeavour	1/01/08
462	Summer travel delays	1/01/08

465	Jenna Bush engaged	1/01/08
467	Leona Helmsley dies	1/01/08
473	Alberto Gonzales resigns	1/01/08
475	Larry Craig arrested for lewd behavior	1/01/08
480	Steve Fossett, aviator, missing	1/01/08
488	September 11 Commemorations	1/01/08
497	Emmy Awards	1/01/08
500	Dan Rather sues CBS, Viacom	1/01/08
501	Jena, Louisiana, legal and civil rights controversies	1/01/08
502	Norman Hsu fundraising scandal	1/01/08
506	Myanmar protests	1/01/08
510	Phil Spector trial	1/01/08
513	Warren Jeffs polygamist trial	1/01/08
514	Baseball playoffs	1/01/08
516	Phoenix airport death of Carol Ann Gotbaum	1/01/08
519	Marion Jones steroid scandal	1/01/08
522	Wisconsin sheriff kills six	1/01/08
523	Nobel prizes	1/01/08
524	October heat wave	1/01/08
531	Staph infection superbug	1/01/08
533	Western Wildfires, beginning Oct. 22	1/01/08
543	Hollywood writers' strike	1/01/08
549	Oprah's South Africa school scandal	1/01/08
559	Veterans Day	1/01/08
563	Travel during the holidays	1/01/08
564	Stacey Peterson scandal	1/01/08
566	Bangladesh cyclone	1/01/08
567	Thanksgiving holiday	1/01/08
568	Natalee Holloway disappearance	1/01/08
572	Baby Grace case in Texas	1/01/08
573	Paris suburb riots	1/01/08
578	Hugo Chavez/Venezuela referendum	1/01/08
584	Pearl Harbor anniversary	1/01/08
594	China	1/01/08
595	Russia	1/01/08
600	Jamie Lynn Spears is pregnant	1/01/08
601	Tiger escapes San Francisco zoo	1/01/08
602	Panama plane crash with U.S. survivor	1/01/08
604	Midwest snowstorm, beginning Dec. 24	1/01/08
606	Kenya election and violence	1/01/08
607	US Diplomat shot in Sudan	1/01/08
608	New Year's resolutions/celebrations	1/01/08
609	Escaped prisoner in Maryland shot, captured	1/02/08
610	Missing hiker, Meredith Emerson, in Georgia	1/03/08
611	Snowstorms in the West, three or more dead	1/06/08
612	Tornadoes in winter	1/07/08

613	Bush trip to Middle East	1/07/08
614	Joe Gibbs of Redskins resigns	1/08/08
615	Bank of America buys Countrywide	1/11/08
616	Edmund Hillary dies	1/10/08
617	Missing Marine Maria Lauterbach	1/10/08
618	Football playoffs/ Super Bowl	1/13/08
619	Northeast snowstorm, beginning Jan. 13	1/13/08
620	Cold medicines too risky for kids	1/17/08
621	Heathrow airport crash-landing	1/17/08
622	Bobby Fischer dies	1/18/08
624	Heath Ledger dies	1/22/08
625	Egypt allowing Palestinians to cross border	1/23/08
626	Monte Carlo, Las Vegas hotel fire	1/25/08
627	Bush's 2008 State of Union speech	1/27/08
628	Mormon leader Gordon Hinckley dies	1/27/08
629	Internet outage in Asia, Middle East	1/31/08
630	Microsoft bids for Yahoo	2/01/08
631	Bush 2008 budget proposal	2/03/08
632	Illinois shooting in store	2/02/08
633	Southern tornadoes on Super Tuesday	2/05/08
634	Snow in Midwest, beginning Feb. 6	2/06/08
635	Elementary school shooting in Ohio	2/07/08
636	Georgia refinery blast	2/07/08
637	Missouri shooting at council meeting	2/07/08
638	Louisiana Tech shooting	2/08/08
639	Dept. of Justice charges Dongfan Chung w/ spying for China	2/11/08
640	Representative Tom Lantos dies	2/11/08
641	Hezbollah leader Imad Mughniyeh killed in Syria	2/13/08
642	Northern Illinois University shootings	2/14/08
643	GM record loss of $39 billion	2/12/08
644	Kosovo declares independence from Serbia	2/17/08
645	Largest ever beef recall	2/17/08
646	Bush's trip to Africa	2/17/08
647	Satellite brought down by Navy missile	2/17/08
648	Nevada earthquake	2/21/08
649	Motorcade officer w/ Clinton killed in accident	2/22/08
650	Pew Forum survey on religion	2/24/08
651	American Airlines passenger dies during flight	2/24/08
652	Microsoft fined $1.3 billion by European Union	2/27/08
653	Senator Robert Byrd's health	2/27/08
654	William F. Buckley dies	2/27/08
655	Bush's press conference on Feb. 28	2/28/08
656	Florida power outage	2/27/08
657	Chicago mall explosion	2/28/08
658	Toxin found at Las Vegas Hotel	2/29/08
659	U.S. missile attacks against Somalia	3/03/08

661	Brett Favre to retire	3/04/08
662	South America tensions (Venezuela, Colombia, etc)	3/04/08
663	Times Square blast	3/06/08
664	University of North Carolina Student killed	3/07/08
665	Six found dead in Memphis home	3/04/08
666	Spitzer involved w/ prostitution ring	3/10/08
667	Tainted drinking water reports	3/10/08
668	Admiral William Fallon resigns	3/11/08
669	Midwest storms	3/19/08
671	Detroit Mayor Kilpatrick charges	3/24/08
672	Plane safety	3/24/08
673	Bear Stearns sale to JP Morgan	3/24/08
674	Federal Reserve regulatory charges	3/31/08
675	Zimbabwe elections	3/31/08
676	Housing Secretary A. Jackson resigns	3/31/08
677	Bush's trip to Europe	3/31/08
678	Charlton Heston dies	4/05/08
679	Tornadoes, storms in Texas, Arkansas, Oklahoma	4/09/08
680	Pope visits U.S.	4/09/08
681	Cyberspace issues	4/11/08
682	Food shortages worldwide	4/07/08
683	Delta, Northwest airlines to merge	4/15/08
684	Congo place crash	4/15/08
685	Colorado wildfires	4/16/08
686	Fresno high school student shot	4/17/08
687	Illinois earthquake	4/18/08
688	NY Times story about military analyst/pundits	4/20/08
689	Petraeus takes over U.S. central command	4/23/08
690	Syria nuclear reactor	4/24/08
691	Train crash in China kills 66	4/27/08
692	Austrian house w/ hostages	4/27/08
693	California wildfires	4/27/08
694	Virginia tornadoes	4/29/08
695	Hannah Montana/ Miley Cyrus photos	4/28/08
696	Arkansas, Missouri storms, on May 1	5/01/08
697	Fort Bragg barracks conditions	5/01/08
698	Myanmar cyclone	5/04/08
699	Kentucky Derby	5/05/08
700	San Diego University drug bust	5/06/08
701	Philadelphia police beating controversy	5/06/08
702	Israel turns 60 years old	5/05/08
703	Chinese earthquake	5/12/08
704	Storms in Oklahoma, Missouri over Mother's day weekend	5/10/08
705	Bush trip to the Middle East	5/12/08
706	Florida fires	5/12/08
707	India blasts	5/13/08

708	R. Kelly trial	5/12/08
709	Mississippi House race	5/13/08
710	Robert Raischenberg, artist, dies	5/13/08
711	Myspace suicide case of Lori Drew	5/15/08
712	Ted Kennedy's health	5/18/08
713	Farm bill in congress	5/18/08
714	California wildfires near Santa Cruz	5/22/08
715	Colorado tornado	5/22/08
716	Sydney Pollack dies	5/26/08
717	Mars Lander Phoenix	5/26/08
718	Iowa, Minnestoa tornadoes	5/25/08
719	Scott McClellan's book about Bush	5/28/08
720	Crane collapses in Manhattan	5/30/08
721	Bo Diddley Dies	6/02/08
722	General Motors to close four truck plants	6/03/08
723	Yves Saint Laurent dies	6/02/08
724	U.S. and British diplomats attacked in Zimbabwe	6/05/08
725	Air Force officials resign	6/05/08
726	Dow drops 400 points	6/06/08
727	Texas Governor mansion fire	6/08/08
728	Violent weather in Midwest and East	6/04/08
729	Tokyo knife attacks	6/08/08
730	Bush's last EU summit	6/09/08
731	Tomatoes salmonella scare	6/09/08
732	Sudan plane catches fire	6/10/08
733	East Coast heat wave	6/09/08
734	Boy Scout camp in Iowa hit by tornado	6/12/08
735	DC power outage and fire	6/13/08
736	Tim Russert dies	6/13/08
737	George Carlin dies	6/23/08
738	Philippine ferry capsized	6/23/08
739	Kentucky plant shootings	6/23/08
740	Florida buys sugar tract for Everglades	6/23/08
741	California wildfires	6/23/08
742	Massachusetts high school pregnancy pact	6/25/08
743	DC handgun ban struck down by Supreme Court	6/26/08
744	Stocks drop, hit 2 year low	6/26/08
745	Dead soldier, Megan Touma, found in bathtub	6/27/08
746	Helicopter crash in Arizona	6/30/08
747	Missing girl in Vermont, Brooke Bennett	7/02/08
748	American hostages rescued in Columbia	7/02/08
749	Starbucks closing stores	7/01/08
750	Jesse Helms, Senator from North Carolina, dies	7/07/08
751	General Motors troubles	7/07/08
752	Istanbul attack on U.S. Consulate	7/09/08
753	Hurricane Bertha	7/09/08

754	A-Rod's sordid divorce	7/10/08
755	Jon Benet Ramsey case developments	7/10/08
756	Fannie Mae/ Freddie Mac troubles	7/15/08
757	Chandra Levy developments, Washington Post story	7/15/08
758	Anheuser-Busch sale to InBev	7/15/08
759	Batman film release	7/18/08
760	Missing persons	7/21/08
761	U.S. airline industry	7/21/08
762	U.S. auto industry	7/21/08
763	Tropical Storm Dolly to hit Texas, Mexico	7/21/08
764	Zaradzic arrested in Belgrade	7/22/08
765	Estelle Getty dies	7/22/08
766	Caylee Anthony, missing two-year-old	7/24/08
767	Qantas jet emergency landing	7/28/08
768	Christian Bale scandal	7/28/08
770	Tennessee church shooting	7/29/08
771	Earthquake near Los Angeles	7/29/08
772	Yosemite fire	7/30/08
773	Anthrax case, suspect suicide/ settlement	8/04/08
774	Tropical Storm Edouard	8/04/08
775	Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn dies	8/05/08
776	Asia trip for Bush	8/05/08
777	K2 tragedy/ rescue	8/06/08
778	Morgan Freeman car accident	8/08/08
779	John Edwards affair	8/08/08
780	Bernie Mac dies	8/11/08
781	Clark Rockefeller kidnapping charges	8/11/08
782	Shooting at Arkansas Democratic Party HQ	8/13/08
783	Georgia/ Russia conflict	8/11/08
784	Tropical Storm Fay	8/18/08
785	Grand Canyon flooding	8/19/08
786	Madrid plane crash	8/20/08
787	Stephanie Tubb Jones, U.S. Representative, death	8/21/08
788	Hurricane Gustav	8/27/08
789	Google launches Chrome	9/02/08
790	Thailand protests/ unrest	9/02/08
791	India flooding	9/02/08
792	Hurricane Hanna	9/02/08
793	TV switch from analog to digital	9/04/08
794	Dick Cheney tours ex-Soviet nations	9/05/08
795	Hurricane Ike	9/05/08
796	Bob Woodward's book, The War Within	9/08/08
797	Financial crisis/ Fed bailout	9/15/08
798	Sex for oil scandal at the Interior Department	9/11/08
799	CERN, big bang machine	9/11/08
800	Los Angeles train crash	9/12/08

801	U.S. Embassy attacked in Yemen	9/17/08
802	European tourists kidnapped in Egypt	9/22/08
803	Finland school shooting	9/23/08
804	Tropical Storm Kyle	9/26/08
805	Paul Newman dies	9/29/08
806	Bloomberg tries for third term	10/01/08
807	Fatal Los Angeles bus crash	10/06/08
808	Ukraine elections	10/10/08
809	Northern California bus crash kills 10	10/10/08
810	Southern California wildfires, beginning October 13	10/13/08
811	Nancy Reagan breaks her hip	10/15/08
812	Tim Mahoney scandal	10/16/08
813	Jennifer Hudson’s mother and brother killed	10/27/08
814	Central Arkansas University shooting	10/27/08
815	Congo civil war	10/29/08
816	State ballot initiatives for 2008	10/29/08
817	Presidential election results	11/05/08
818	New Obama Administration	11/05/08
819	State governments/ Gubernatorial races	11/05/08
820	Congressional election results	11/05/08
821	New 111th Congress	11/05/08
822	Interior Minister killed in Mexico plane crash	11/05/08
823	Michael Crichton dies	11/05/08
824	Barney bites reporter	11/06/08
825	Blizzard in the Dakotas	11/07/08
826	President Bush's last days in White House	11/10/08
827	Southern California wildfires, beginning November 10	11/10/08
828	Mexican drug war	11/17/08
829	Somali pirates	11/17/08
830	Eight-year-old boy killed father	11/21/08
831	Mukasey’s health	11/21/08
832	Mumbai terror attacks	11/26/08
833	Plaxico Burres gun case	12/01/08
834	Greece riots over teen death	12/09/08
835	Illinois Governor Blagojevich, Senate Seat, scandal	12/10/08
836	Newspaper industry troubles	12/10/08
837	San Diego Marine plane crash kills family	12/10/08
838	East Coast storms	12/10/08
839	Bush’s last trip to Iraq and Afghanistan	12/15/08
840	Madoff banking scam	12/16/08
841	Rwanda genocide mastermind convicted	12/18/08
842	Deep Throat, Mark Felt dies	12/19/08
843	Severe winter weather across U.S.	12/19/08
844	Sherry Johnston, Bristol Palin's mother-in-law, drug charge	12/19/08
845	Continental jet skids off runway in Denver	12/22/08
846	Water main break in Maryland	12/23/08

847	Santa suit gunman in California	12/24/08
848	Tennessee coal ash accident	12/24/08
849	Cruise ship accident of Jennifer Seitz	12/30/08
850	Avalanche in British Columbia	12/30/08
852	Thailand nightclub fire	12/30/08
853	Midwest, Northwest nasty winter weather	12/30/08
860	Harold Pinter dies	12/25/08
861	Eartha Kitt dies	12/25/08
999	No Big Story	1/01/08

SUB-STORYLINE (some BIG STORIES only)

Definition: The sub-storyline will apply only to stories that fit into SOME of the long-running Big Stories, or other common storylines (such as political campaigns), reflecting aspects, features or development of some big stories. As with the big story code this list is updated throughout the year.

For example, stories that fit into the Big Story of "Iraq War-Events on the Ground" could have several options for its "sub-storyline" such as a focus on casualties, Iraqi internal affairs, or the rebuilding effort. Many big stories that are less complex will likely not have any sub-storyline. Therefore, this variable will be N/A for stories that fall into a one-tiered Big Story or no Big Story.

Procedure: Find the big story located on the list of Sub-storylines and determine if the majority of the relevant parts of the story fit into any of the SUB-STORYLINES offered. If the story could fit into more than one sub-storyline, determine which storyline is given more space or time. If the article does not fit into any of the sub-storylines offered, code as OTHER.

Codes:		**Date Added**
Immigration debate		
002001	Rallies and protests	1/01/08
002002	Discussion of legislation	1/01/08
002003	Border security plans and actions	1/01/08
002004	Political or campaign ramifications	1/01/08
002005	Immigrant crime	1/01/08
002006	National legislation	4/21/08
002007	State and local legislation, action	4/21/08
002008	ICE raids	4/21/08
002009	Immigrant labor	4/21/08
002999	Other	1/01/08
Same-sex marriage debate		
003001	State legislation	1/01/08
003002	Court decisions	1/01/08

003003	Political ramifications	1/01/08
003999	Other	1/01/08
U.S. Domestic terrorism and efforts to combat		
005001	Legislation in regards to	1/01/08
005002	NSA easedropping program	1/01/08
005004	Arrests of domestic accused terrorists	1/01/08
005005	Guantanamo Bay controversy	1/01/08
005006	Effectiveness of Homeland Security	1/01/08
005007	Political ramifications of policies	1/01/08
005009	Debate over civil rights	1/01/08
005010	Debate over torture tactics	1/01/08
005011	Audit of FBI snooping	1/01/08
005012	Khaled Sheikh Mohammed confession	1/01/08
005014	Jose Padilla trial	1/01/08
005015	9/11 news	1/01/08
005018	Airport security	1/01/08
005019	Destroyed CIA interrogation tapes	1/01/08
005020	Death penalty charge for six in 9/11 attacks	2/11/08
005021	USS Cole bombing and developments	7/01/08
005022	Trial of Osama's taxi driver	7/17/08
005023	WMD congressional report	12/05/08
005999	Other	1/01/08
CIA leak/Valerie Plame leak investigation		
008001	Political ramifications	1/01/08
008002	Scooter Libby indictment	1/01/08
008999	Other	1/01/08
Enron scandal		
010001	Court trial	1/01/08
010999	Other	1/01/08
U.S. economy		
011001	Housing	1/01/08
011002	Unemployment and jobs	1/01/08
011003	Interest rates	1/01/08
011004	Retail	1/01/08
011005	Possibility of a recession	1/13/08
011006	Stocks drop around world	1/21/08
011007	Tax rebate checks	4/28/08
011008	Food prices	6/13/08
011999	Other	1/01/08
Duke University lacrosse scandal		
012999	None	1/01/08
Conflict in the Middle East between Israel and Lebanon		
013999	None	1/01/08
Conflict in the Middle East between Israelis and Palestinians		
014001	Negotiations	1/01/08
014002	Violence	1/01/08

014003	Israeli seminary attack	3/04/08
014999	Other	1/01/08
North Korea nuclear conflict		
016001	North Korea tests missile	1/01/08
016002	Korean leaders summit	1/01/08
016003	NY Philharmonic plays Pyongyang	2/24/08
016004	Kim Jong Il's Health	9/09/08
016999	Other	1/01/08
War in Afghanistan		
017001	U.S. political ramifications	1/01/08
017002	Combat, violence, casualties	1/01/08
017003	Reconstruction efforts	1/01/08
017004	Democracy efforts	1/01/08
017005	Return of drug economy	1/01/08
017007	Debate over U.S. strategy policy	1/01/08
017009	Re-emergence of Al Qaeda and Taliban	1/01/08
017011	Taliban leader Mullah Padullah killed	1/01/08
017013	Prince Harry leaving Afghanistan	2/27/08
017014	U.S. strike on Afghanistan/ Pakistan border	6/10/08
017015	Debate on moving Iraq troops to Afghanistan	7/18/08
017999	Other	1/01/08
Iran		
018001	Iran's weapons	1/01/08
018002	Iran's role in Iraq war	1/01/08
018006	Ahmadinejad visits U.S.	1/01/08
018007	Iranian internal affairs	1/01/08
018008	Iran gunships harass U.S. ships	1/05/08
018009	Israel and Iran	7/01/08
018999	Other	1/01/08
Congressional political corruption scandals		
019001	Abramoff scandal	1/01/08
019003	Bob Ney scandal	1/01/08
019004	William Jefferson	1/01/08
019005	Ted Stevens	1/01/08
019999	Other	1/01/08
NASA and Space Shuttle Discovery		
020999	None	1/01/08
Hurricane Katrina aftermath		
021001	Reconstruction efforts	1/01/08
021002	FEMA aid or response	1/01/08
021003	Preparation for future hurricanes	1/01/08
021004	Crime in devastated areas	1/01/08
021999	Other	1/01/08
Global warming		
022001	Politics of global warming	1/01/08
022002	Potential legislation	1/01/08

022003	Scientific debate	1/01/08
022004	California tightens rules on emissions	1/01/08
022999	Other	1/01/08
Supreme Court actions		
023999	None	1/01/08
Abortion controversy		
024001	Court cases and legal issues	1/01/08
024002	Political ramifications	1/01/08
024003	Protests and rallies	1/01/08
024999	Other	1/01/08
Stem cell research controversy		
025999	None	1/01/08
General Middle East discussion		
026999	None	1/01/08
Steve Irwin, the crocodile hunter, dies		
027999	None	1/01/08
Mark Foley page scandal		
031005	Criminal investigation	1/01/08
031999	Other	1/01/08
Baseball steroids scandal		
035001	Barry Bonds accusations	1/01/08
035999	Other	1/01/08
War on Terror general		
037001	Re-emergence of Al Qaeda	1/01/08
037999	Other	1/01/08
Conflict in Sudan/Darfur		
042999	None	1/01/08
Madonna and child		
052999	None	1/01/08
Pastor Ted Haggard scandal		
059999	None	1/01/08
Presidential bids for 2008		
Mostly Democrats		
067101	Fundraising	1/01/08
067102	Strategy, momentum, performance, polls	1/01/08
067103	Political topics other	1/01/08
067104	Electoral calendar	1/01/08
067110	Personal topics	1/01/08
067115	Immigration	1/01/08
067116	Abortion	1/01/08
067117	Health care	1/01/08
067130	Domestic policy issue other	1/01/08
067131	Iraq War	1/01/08
067139	Foreign policy issue other	1/01/08
067199	Other	1/01/08
Mostly Republicans		

067201	Fundraising	1/01/08
067202	Strategy, momentum, performance, polls	1/01/08
067203	Political topics other	1/01/08
067204	Electoral calendar	1/01/08
067210	Personal topics	1/01/08
067215	Immigration	1/01/08
067216	Abortion	1/01/08
067217	Health care	1/01/08
067230	Domestic policy issue other	1/01/08
067231	Iraq War	1/01/08
067239	Foreign policy issue other	1/01/08
067299	Other	1/01/08
Mix of Democrats and Republicans		
067301	Fundraising	1/01/08
067302	Strategy, momentum, performance, polls	1/01/08
067303	Political topics other	1/01/08
067304	Electoral calendar	1/01/08
067310	Personal topics	1/01/08
067315	Immigration	1/01/08
067316	Abortion	1/01/08
067317	Health care	1/01/08
067330	Domestic policy issue other	1/01/08
067331	Iraq War	1/01/08
067339	Foreign policy issue other	1/01/08
067399	Other	1/01/08
3rd Party		
067400	3rd parties	1/01/08
067990	Electoral Calendar	1/01/08

Note: The above presidential bid sub-stories were used until 1/08/08. From 1/9/08 onward, we used the sub-stories below.

067501	Clinton, Obama spar over MLK comments	1/13/08
067502	McCain momentum after NH	1/13/08
067503	Romney's Michigan primary win and momentum	1/16/08
067504	role of Bill Clinton	1/21/08
067505	Kennedy family endorses Obama	1/28/08
067506	GOP Florida primary	1/28/08
067507	John Edwards drops out	1/30/08
067508	Giuliani drops out and endorses McCain	1/29/08
067509	McCain's attempts to unite GOP	2/06/08
067510	Romney suspends campaign/ drops out	2/07/08
067511	Clinton changes campaign staff	2/11/08
067512	Superdelegates for Dems	2/11/08
067513	McCain scandal – ethics/ lobby history	2/20/08
067514	Obama rumors – not patriotic/ tied to Islam	3/03/08

067515	Huckabee drops out of race	3/04/08
067516	Bush endorses McCain	3/05/08
067517	Florida and Michigan primary re-do?	3/10/08
067518	Obama's relationship with Rev. Wright	3/17/08
067519	Richardson endorses Obama	3/21/08
067520	Candidate passport files breached	3/20/08
067521	Clinton's Bosnia story	3/24/08
067522	Carville calls Richardson "Judas"	3/24/08
067523	Gordon Fischer compares B. Clinton to McCarthy	3/24/08
067524	McCain's position on Iraq	3/24/08
067525	Calls for Hillary to drop out of race	3/31/08
067526	McCain's choices for VP	3/31/08
067527	Clinton strategist Mark Penn quits	4/06/08
067528	Candidates at the Petraeus hearings	4/08/08
067529	Obama's "bitter" remark	4/09/08
067530	Pennsylvania Democratic Debate	4/16/08
067531	Pennsylvania Democratic primary	4/21/08
067532	McCain's relationship with Pastor Hagee	4/23/08
067533	McCain's use of wife's plane	4/27/08
067534	Joe Andrews switches support to Obama	5/01/08
067535	Price of gas as an issue	4/30/08
067536	Operation chaos by Rush Limbaugh	5/05/08
067537	Obama's VP search (non about Clinton)	5/05/08
067538	Divided Democratic party/ Efforts to unite	5/05/08
067539	Bob Barr as potential spoiler	5/12/08
067540	Obama's race, related to electability?	5/12/08
067541	Edwards endorses Obama	5/14/08
067542	Bush/ McCain say Obama appeases terrorists	5/15/08
067543	Michelle Obama's role	5/19/08
067544	McCain's health/age	5/19/08
067545	Clinton comment about B. Kennedy assassination	5/23/08
067546	Bush's relationship w/ McCain	5/26/08
067547	Obama remark about uncle in WWII	5/26/08
067548	Iraq war as an issue	5/26/08
067549	Rev. Michael Pfleger comments	5/29/08
067550	Obama leaves Trinity Church	6/01/08
067551	Clinton as possible VP	6/02/08
067552	Obama as historic nominee	6/02/08
067553	Experience as an issue	6/02/08
067555	Health care as issue	6/02/08
067556	Immigration as issue	6/02/08
067557	Clinton to suspend campaign	6/04/08
067558	Clinton's campaign review – mistakes/sexism?	6/09/08
067559	McCain v Obama polls	6/09/08
067560	Jim Johnson as vetter for Obama	6/09/08
067561	Rezko relationship w/ Obama	6/09/08

067562	Obama's comments about black fathers	6/16/08
067563	Democratic Convention in Denver	6/16/08
067564	Republican Convention in Minneapolis	6/16/08
067565	Gore endorses Obama	6/16/08
067566	Clayton Williams' role with McCain	6/16/08
067567	Terrorism/security as an issue	6/16/08
067568	Energy as an issue	6/16/08
067569	Environment as an issue	6/18/08
067570	Campaign fundraising	6/19/08
067571	Role of Cindy McCain	6/19/08
067572	McCain strategist on terror	6/24/08
067573	Obama ditches campaign seal	6/24/08
067575	James Dobson and Obama	6/24/08
067576	Obama is an elitist?	6/25/08
067577	Role of Ralph Nader	6/26/08
067578	Crimes/ Guns as an Iassue	6/26/08
067579	Candidates reach out to evangelicals/religious voters	6/27/08
067580	Obama's moves to the middle/ flip-flopper	6/30/08
067581	McCain's truth squad/Wesley Clark comments	6/30/08
067582	McCain in a flip-flopper	6/30/08
067583	Role of the internet in campaigns	7/01/08
067584	Obama's discount mortgage	7/02/08
067585	McCain campaign shake-up	7/03/08
067586	Same-sex marriage as an issue	7/03/08
067587	Abortion as an Issue	7/03/08
067588	McCain's temper	7/07/08
067589	$3 million energy attack ad against Obama	7/07/08
067590	Obama going after red states	7/08/08
067591	Iran as an issue	7/09/08
067592	Candidates go after Hispanic vote/ Hispanic voters	7/09/08
067593	Access Hollywood interviews Obama daughters	7/09/08
067594	Jesse Jackson's Obama comments overheard	7/09/08
067596	Campaign generated ads	7/10/08
067597	Outside ads for or against candidates	7/10/08
067598	Gramm's comments about a nation of whiners	7/11/08
067599	Brandenburg gate; intended Obama speech location	7/07/08
067600	New Yorker controversy	7/15/08
067601	Afghanistan as an issue	7/15/08
067602	Foreign policy general	7/15/08
067603	Obama/ McCain speak at NAACP	7/18/08
067604	Iraq, overseas trip for Obama	7/18/08
067605	Press coverage of Obama	7/21/08
067606	Rick Warren church forum	7/21/08
067607	Dalai Lama meets with McCain	7/25/08
067608	Is Obama presumptuous?	7/30/08

067610	Race card played by campaigns	8/01/08
067611	McCain visit Sturgis, ND	8/05/08
067613	Obama fatigue	8/06/08
067614	Hawaiian vacation for Obama	8/08/08
067615	Hillary's/ Supporters' role at the convention	8/08/08
067616	Candidates responses to Russia/Georgia	8/11/08
067617	Edwards' effect on the campaign	8/12/08
067618	Republicans for Obama	8/13/08
067619	Colin Powell to endorse Obama	8/14/08
067620	Jerome Corsi book, Obamanation	8/14/08
067621	Obama gets tougher, Sharpens attacks	8/20/08
067622	Candidates attack each other over houses	8/21/08
067624	Biden Named VP	8/21/08
067625	Sara Palin for VP	8/29/08
067626	Ted Kennedy at convention	8/26/08
067627	Assassination attempt at convention	8/27/08
067628	Bill Ayers relationship with Obama	8/27/08
067629	Convention speech by Obama	8/28/08
067630	Hurricane Gustav to delay Republican Convention?	8/29/08
067631	Profile of Obama	8/29/08
067632	Profile of McCain	8/29/08
067633	Family/ scandals for Palin/ teen pregnancy	9/02/08
067634	Public record for Palin as governor/ mayor	9/02/08
067635	Bush and the GOP convention	9/03/08
067636	GOP attack on media/ McCain v. liberal press	9/04/08
067637	Convention speech by McCain	9/04/08
067638	O'Reilly to host Obama interview	9/04/08
067639	Sexism and Sara Palin	9/04/08
067641	Change candidate, Maverick McCain	9/05/08
067642	Change we can believe in candidate, Obama	9/05/08
067643	MSNBC anchor shuffle over campaign coverage	9/08/08
067644	ABC, Charlie Gibson interview with Palin	9/09/08
067645	Attacks by Obama/ Biden against Palin	9/09/08
067646	Women voters turn to/ away from Palin	9/09/08
067647	"Lipstick on a pig" comments by Obama	9/10/08
067648	Lobbyists and campaigns	9/11/08
067649	Swing, red states and the campaigns	9/11/08
067650	Stem cell as an issue	9/11/08
067651	Todd Palin's campaign, advisor role	9/19/08
067653	September 26 debate	9/23/08
067654	October 2 VP debate	9/23/08
067655	UN visit: Palin meets world leaders	9/23/08
067656	McCain calls to delay the campaign & debate	9/24/08
067657	Biden's gaffes	9/25/08
067658	Couric interviews Palin	9/22/08
067659	Conservatives/ Republicans move away from Palin	9/29/08

067660	Pastors preach politics from the pulpit	9/29/08
067661	Early voting begins	10/01/08
067662	Gwen Ifill "Age of Obama" Book controversy	10/01/08
067663	Electoral map math	10/02/08
067664	Voting issues and irregularities	10/02/08
067665	October 6 presidential debate	10/03/08
067666	"Keating 5" association for McCain	10/06/08
067667	SNL, Tina Fey and the campaign	10/06/08
067670	Character, connection attacks by Obama camp	10/07/08
067671	October 15 presidential debate	10/09/08
067672	McCain is a underdog/ fighter	10/14/08
067673	Joe the plumber	10/16/08
067674	Obama visits grandmother	10/21/08
067675	Battered girl w backwards 'B'	10/20/08
067676	Dissent, finger pointing within GOP/ Palin goes rogue	10/27/08
067677	Tennessee white supremacist plot to kill Obama	10/28/08
067678	Ted Stevens' effect on campaign	10/30/08
067679	November 4 elections, straight results	11/04/08
067681	Economy and financial crisis	6/02/08
067682	Attacks by McCain camp	7/30/08
067996	Multiple storylines	6/16/08
067997	Description day's events/straight	6/16/08
067999	Other	1/01/08

New Democratic-lead Congress

070999	None	1/01/08

O.J. Simpson

078999	None	1/01/08

Video game consoles (Microsoft, Nintendo, etc.)

079999	None	1/01/08

Russian spy Litvinenko poisoning/ death

086999	None	1/01/08

Holiday Season

087001	Giving and charities	1/01/08
087002	Shopping and business	1/01/08
087003	"War on Christmas"	1/01/08
087999	Other	1/01/08

NY Cops shoot unarmed man, Sean Bell

089999	None	1/01/08

Iraq War - events on the ground

100001	U.S. Combat/violence/casualties	1/01/08
100002	Civil combat/violence/casualties not involving U.S.	1/01/08
100003	U.S. soldiers charged with crimes	1/01/08
100004	Reconstruction efforts	1/01/08
100005	Reconstruction waste, corruption	1/01/08

100006	Iraqi internal affairs	1/01/08
100010	Iraqi Refugees	1/01/08
100011	Iraqi protests and rallies	1/01/08
100012	U.S. troops in Iraq (other than fighting/combat)	1/01/08
100014	Evaluations of U.S. troop surge	1/01/08
100016	Private contractors	1/01/08
100017	Claims of victory for al Qaeda in Iraq	1/01/08
100018	Turkey-Iraq border tensions	1/01/08
100019	Al Qaeda/ Bin Laden role in Iraq	1/01/08
100020	al Qaeda leader in Iraq captured or not?	5/08/08
100021	Transition from combat to training Iraqis	6/02/08
100022	Iraqi views of U.S. presence	6/09/08
100023	Reports of progress	6/23/08
100024	Reports of prisoner abuse	7/02/08
100025	U.S. cross border raids into Syria	10/27/08
100026	Security agreement for Iraq, w/ 2011 deadline	11/17/08
100999	Other	1/01/08
Iraq War – U.S. homefront		
101001	Homecomings, funerals, celebrations	1/01/08
101002	Military recruitment	1/01/08
101003	Effect on communities, families	1/01/08
101004	Iraq refugees to U.S.	1/01/08
101005	Conditions of wounded veterans in U.S.	1/01/08
101006	U.S. soldier deployments	1/01/08
101007	Cindy Sheehan	1/01/08
101999	Other	1/01/08
Iraq War - policy debate		
102001	Debate over U.S. strategy policy	1/01/08
102003	Political ramifications for U.S. politicians	1/01/08
102004	Anti-war protests and speeches	1/01/08
102005	Debate over media coverage	1/01/08
102007	Policy debate of U.S. Allies (Britain, Poland, etc.)	1/01/08
102009	Policy debate involving Iraq's neighbors (Iran, Syria, etc.)	1/01/08
102010	Role of Iraq government and security forces	1/01/08
102012	2007 troop increase	1/01/08
102016	Iraq War as central front on War on Terror	1/01/08
102018	Comparisons to Vietnam	1/01/08
102022	Rush Limbaugh's phony soldiers comment	1/01/08
102023	Petraeus/Crocker testimony	4/08/08
102024	Debate over troop levels, drawdowns etc	9/09/08
102999	Other	1/01/08
Princess Diana – questions about death		
167999	None	1/01/08
Palestinian conflict – rival factions in Gaza		
175999	None	1/01/08

Libya sentences Bulgarian nurses to death		
177999	None	1/01/08
Somalia/Ethiopia conflict		
187999	None	1/01/08
Apple introduces iPhone		
195999	None	1/01/08
MLK holiday/remembrances		
204999	None	1/01/08
Golden Globe Awards		
205999	None	1/01/08
Cuba		
207002	Future of Cuba	2/17/08
207003	U.S. - Cuba relations	2/17/08
207004	Castro history/retrospective	2/17/08
207005	Cuban-American reaction to Castro resignation	2/17/08
207999	Other	1/01/08
American Idol TV show		
211999	None	1/01/08
Oscar awards		
215999	None	1/01/08
Energy debate		
221999	None	1/01/08
Health care debate		
222999	None	1/01/08
Barbaro euthanized		
224999	None	1/01/08
2008 Congressional campaigns		
233001	Democrats	1/01/08
233002	Republicans	1/01/08
233003	Both parties	1/01/08
233004	Election results, straight	11/04/08
233999	Other	1/01/08
Anna Nicole Smith dies		
243999	None	1/01/08
Grammy awards		
244999	None	1/01/08
XM/Sirius satellite radio merger		
256999	None	1/01/08
Britney Spears		
260999	None	1/01/08
HPV cervical cancer vaccine		
261999	None	1/01/08
Talk show host wars for cable/ radio news		
267001	Fox News vs. NBC/ MSNBC	1/01/08
267999	Other	1/01/08
Bus crash with baseball team in Atlanta		

270999	None	1/01/08
Dick Cheney's health		
272999	None	1/01/08
Fired U.S. attorney controversy		
276001	2008 report on DOJ hiring practices	7/29/08
276002	Special prosecution to investigate case	9/29/08
276999	Other	1/01/08
John Couey convicted of killing Jessica Lunsford		
277999	None	1/01/08
NCAA basketball tournament		
282999	None	1/01/08
Gas/oil prices		
283001	Increase in public transportation	6/09/08
283002	People changing habits to save on gas	6/09/08
283003	Impact on airlines and flying	6/09/08
283004	Other businesses impacted by rising costs	6/09/08
283005	Political ramifications for Bush and Congress	6/09/08
283006	Amount of prices	6/30/08
283007	Effect of financial crisis	9/23/08
283999	Other	1/01/08
Gays in the military		
286999	None	1/01/08
Pet food/Chinese product recall		
289001	Chinese milk in the U.S.	9/26/08
289999	Other	1/01/08
Tony Snow's health		
293999	None	1/01/08
White House political scandal		
297999	None	1/01/08
Heart disease research		
299999	None	1/01/08
German polar bear Knut		
300999	None	1/01/08
Taxes/Tax day		
306999	None	1/01/08
Don Imus's controversial comments		
309999	None	1/01/08
Masters Golf tournament		
311999	None	1/01/08
VA Tech shootings		
316999	None	1/01/08
French elections		
322999	None	1/01/08
Kucinich impeachment effort		
325999	None	1/01/08
Military cover-up? Pat Tillman and Jessica Lynch		

326001	Pat Tillman focused	1/01/08
326003	Both Tillman and Lynch focused	1/01/08
326999	Other	1/01/08
DC escort scandal		
333999	None	1/01/08
Rupert Murdoch bids for Dow Jones/WSJ		
341999	None	1/01/08
Tornadoes in Kansas on May 4		
342999	None	1/01/08
Israel internal politics		
344999	None	1/01/08
Pollution/emissions		
353999	None	1/01/08
Missing girl in Portugal		
355999	None	1/01/08
Lebanon violence		
359999	None	1/01/08
Body armor for U.S. troops		
362002	MRAP vehicle controversy	1/01/08
362999	Other	1/01/08
Memorial Day events/remembrances		
365999	None	1/01/08
Miss Universe/Miss USA		
372999	None	1/01/08
Hurricane season coming		
378999	None	1/01/08
NY Terrorist plot against JFK airport		
379999	None	1/01/08
G-8 Summit		
381999	None	1/01/08
Ohio missing pregnant woman		
396999	None	1/01/08
VP Cheney controversies		
401999	None	1/01/08
Fairness Doctrine		
406999	None	1/01/08
London bomb discovered, Glasgow attack		
407999	None	1/01/08
4th of July celebrations/holiday		
409999	None	1/01/08
Harry Potter		
412999	None	1/01/08
Hot dog eating contest		
415999	None	1/01/08
Catholic Priest abuse scandal		
425999	None	1/01/08

Michael Vick indicted		
428999	None	1/01/08
FDA and tainted imported food		
430999	None	1/01/08
Pakistan		
433001	Pakistani internal/political affairs	1/01/08
433002	Violence and bombings	1/01/08
433003	Al-Qaeda presence	1/01/08
433004	Bhutto assassinated	1/01/08
433005	Elections	1/01/08
433006	25 held in school siege	1/28/08
433007	Musharraf steps down	8/18/08
433008	Escalating tension w/ U.S. military confrontations	9/22/08
433009	Earthquake on 10/29/08	10/29/08
433999	Other	1/01/08
NBA referee scandal		
436999	None	1/01/08
Alberto Gonzales scandals		
442999	None	1/01/08
Minneapolis bridge collapse		
450002	Victim stories	1/01/08
450003	Implications for other bridges	1/01/08
450004	Role of government	1/01/08
450005	Causes and details	1/01/08
450006	Anniversary	8/04/08
450999	Other	1/01/08
Ethics reform bill		
451999	None	1/01/08
Miners trapped after Salt Lake earthquake		
452999	None	1/01/08
2008 Olympics in Beijing		
453001	Protests related to China and Olympics	4/07/08
453002	Environmental concerns	7/10/08
453003	Media Coverage and freedom of press issues	7/10/08
453004	Tourists' concerns	7/10/08
453005	Chinese preparations	7/10/08
453006	Tracking national and local teams and athletes	7/10/08
453007	Steroid concerns	7/10/08
453008	Security concerns and preparations	7/21/08
453009	Straight account of results	7/23/08
453010	Sponsorship, advertisements, business	8/04/08
453011	U.S. Officials at the Games (including Bush)	8/04/08
453012	Ceremonies, opening and closing	8/04/08
453013	Stabbing of volleyball coach's parents	8/11/08
453014	Future of China and how the Olympics will affect it	8/11/08

453015	Recaps of day's events, incl. non-sports	8/11/08
453050	Aquatics (swimming, diving, etc.) - Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453060	Aquatics- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453070	Aquatics- Controversies	8/04/08
453080	Aquatics- Other	8/04/08
453100	Baseball- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453110	Baseball- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453120	Baseball- Controversies	8/04/08
453130	Baseball- Other	8/04/08
453150	Track & Field- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453160	Track & Field- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453170	Track &Field- Controversies	8/04/08
453180	Track & Field-Other	8/04/08
453200	Soccer- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453210	Soccer- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453220	Soccer- Controversies	8/04/08
453230	Soccer- Other	8/04/08
453250	Gymnastics- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453260	Gymnastics- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453270	Gymnastics- Controversies	8/04/08
453280	Gymnastics- Other	8/04/08
453300	Softball- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453310	Softball- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453320	Softball- Controversies	8/04/08
453330	Softball- Other	8/04/08
453350	Tennis- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453360	Tennis- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453370	Tennis- Controversies	8/04/08
453380	Tennis- Other	8/04/08
453400	Volleyball- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453410	Volleyball- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453420	Volleyball- Controversies	8/04/08
453430	Volleyball- Other	8/04/08
453450	Basketball- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453460	Basketball- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453470	Basketball- Controversies	8/04/08
453480	Basketball- Other	8/04/08
453500	Other Sports- Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453510	Other Sports- Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453520	Other Sports- Controversies	8/04/08
453530	Other Sports- Other	8/04/08
453600	Multi-sport (if none is 50% of the story)-Results/summary of events	8/04/08
453610	Multi-sport - Profiles of athletes	8/04/08
453620	Multi-sport – Controversies	8/04/08

453630	Multi-sport – Other	8/04/08
453999	Other	1/01/08
Space shuttle Endeavour		
460999	None	1/01/08
Summer travel delays		
462999	None	1/01/08
Jenna Bush engaged		
465999	None	1/01/08
Leona Helmsley dies		
467999	None	1/01/08
Alberto Gonzales resigns		
473999	None	1/01/08
Larry Craig arrested for lewd behavior		
475999	None	1/01/08
Steve Fossett, aviator, missing		
480999	None	1/01/08
September 11 Commemorations		
488999	None	1/01/08
Emmy Awards		
497999	None	1/01/08
Dan Rather sues CBS, Viacom		
500999	None	1/01/08
Jena, Louisiana, legal and civil rights controversies		
501999	None	1/01/08
Norman Hsu fundraising scandal		
502999	None	1/01/08
Myanmar protests		
506999	None	1/01/08
Phil Spector trial		
510999	None	1/01/08
Warren Jeffs polygamist trial		
513999	None	1/01/08
Baseball playoffs		
514999	None	1/01/08
Phoenix airport death of Carol Ann Gotbaum		
516999	None	1/01/08
Marion Jones steroid scandal		
519999	None	1/01/08
Wisconsin sheriff kills six		
522999	None	1/01/08
Nobel prizes		
523999	None	1/01/08
October heat wave		
524999	None	1/01/08
Staph infection superbug		
531999	None	1/01/08

Western Wildfires beginning Oct. 22		
533999	None	1/01/08
Hollywood writers' strike		
543001	Impact on Golden Globes awards	1/13/08
543999	Other	1/01/08
Oprah's South Africa school scandal		
549999	None	1/01/08
Veterans Day		
559999	None	1/01/08
Travel during the holidays		
563999	None	1/01/08
Stacey Peterson scandal		
564999	None	1/01/08
Bangladesh cyclone		
566999	None	1/01/08
Thanksgiving holiday		
567999	None	1/01/08
Natalee Holloway disappearance		
568999	None	1/01/08
Baby Grace case in Texas		
572999	None	1/01/08
Paris suburb riots		
573999	None	1/01/08
Hugo Chavez/Venezuela referendum		
578999	None	1/01/08
Pearl Harbor anniversary		
584999	None	1/01/08
China		
594001	Internal government and politics	1/01/08
594002	Trade and business practices	1/01/08
594003	Role in international diplomacy	1/01/08
594004	Tibet	3/17/08
594005	Violence (not related to protests)	8/04/08
594006	Human rights issues	8/04/08
594008	Development and construction	8/04/08
594009	Media	8/04/08
594010	New China/changes (socio-political changes)	8/04/08
594011	Tainted and recalled foods and goods (within China)	9/15/08
594999	Other	1/01/08
Russia		
595001	Government/election/politics	1/01/08
595002	Defense and weapons	1/01/08
595003	Conflict with Georgia	1/01/08
595004	Relationship with U.S.	1/01/08
595005	Role in international diplomacy	1/01/08
595006	Eastern Europe missile defense	8/21/08

595999 Other 1/01/08
Jamie Lynn Spears is pregnant
600999 None 1/01/08
Tiger escapes San Francisco zoo
601999 None 1/01/08
Panama plane crash with U.S. survivor
602999 None 1/01/08
Midwest snowstorm, beginning Dec. 24
604999 None 1/01/08
Kenya election and violence
606999 None 1/01/08
US Diplomat shot in Sudan
607999 None 1/01/08
New Year's Resolutions/Celebrations
608999 None 1/01/08
Escaped prisoner in Maryland shot, captured
609999 None 1/02/08
Missing hiker, Meredith Emerson, in Georgia
610999 None 1/03/08
Snowstorms in the West, three or more dead
611999 None 1/06/08
Tornadoes in winter
612999 None 1/07/08
Bush trip to Middle East
613999 None 1/07/08
Joe Gibbs of Redskins resigns
614999 None 1/08/08
Bank of America buys Countrywide
615999 None 1/11/08
Edmund Hillary dies
616999 None 1/10/08
Missing Marine Maria Lauterbach
617999 None 1/10/08
Football playoffs/ Super Bowl
618999 None 1/13/08
Northeast snowstorm, beginning Jan. 13
619999 None 1/13/08
Cold medicines too risky for kids
620999 None 1/17/08
Heathrow airport crash-landing
621999 None 1/17/08
Bobby Fischer dies
622999 None 1/18/08
Heath Ledger dies
624999 None 1/22/08
Egypt allowing Palestinians to cross border

625999	None	1/23/08
Monte Carlo, Las Vegas hotel fire		
626999	None	1/25/08
Bush's 2008 State of Union speech		
627999	None	1/27/08
Mormon leader Gordon Hinckley dies		
628999	None	1/27/08
Internet outage in Asia, Middle East		
629999	None	1/31/08
Microsoft bids for Yahoo		
630999	None	2/01/08
Bush 2008 budget proposal		
631999	None	2/03/08
Illinois shooting in store		
632999	None	2/02/08
Southern tornadoes on Super Tuesday		
633999	None	2/05/08
Snow in Midwest, beginning Feb. 6		
634999	None	2/06/08
Elementary school shooting in Ohio		
635999	None	2/07/08
Georgia refinery blast		
636999	None	2/07/08
Missouri shooting at council meeting		
637999	None	2/07/08
Louisiana Tech shooting		
638999	None	2/08/08
Dept. of Justice charges Dongfan Chung w/ spying for China		
639999	None	2/11/08
Representative Tom Lantos dies		
640999	None	2/11/08
Hezbollah leader Imad Mughniyeh killed in Syria		
641999	None	2/13/08
Northern Illinois University shootings		
642999	None	2/14/08
GM record loss of $39 billion		
643999	None	2/12/08
Kosovo declares independence from Serbia		
644001	U.S. Embassy in Belgrade attacked	2/21/08
644999	Other	2/17/08
Largest ever beef recall		
645999	None	2/17/08
Bush's trip to Africa		
646999	None	2/17/08
Satellite brought down by Navy missile		
647999	None	2/17/08

Nevada earthquake
648999 None 2/21/08
Motorcade officer w/ Clinton killed in accident
649999 None 2/22/08
Pew Forum survey on religion
650999 None 2/24/08
American Airlines passenger dies during flight
651999 None 2/24/08
Microsoft fined $1.3 billion by European Union
652999 None 2/27/08
Senator Robert Byrd's health
653999 None 2/27/08
William F. Buckley dies
654999 None 2/27/08
Bush's press conference on Feb. 28
655999 None 2/28/08
Florida power outage
656999 None 2/27/08
Chicago mall explosion
657999 None 2/28/08
Toxin found at Las Vegas Hotel
658999 None 2/29/08
U.S. missile attacks against Somalia
659999 None 3/03/08
Brett Favre to retire
661999 None 3/04/08
South America tensions (Venezuela, Colombia, etc)
662999 None 3/04/08
Times Square blast
663999 None 3/06/08
University of North Carolina Student killed
664999 None 3/07/08
Six found dead in Memphis home
665999 None 3/04/08
Spitzer involved w/ prostitution ring
666999 None 3/10/08
Tainted drinking water reports
667999 None 3/10/08
Admiral William Fallon resigns
668999 None 3/11/08
Midwest storms
669999 None 3/19/08
Detroit Mayor Kilpatrick charges
671999 None 3/24/08
Plane safety
672999 None 3/24/08

Bear Stearns sale to JP Morgan

673999	None	3/24/08

Federal Reserve regulatory charges

674999	None	3/31/08

Zimbabwe elections

675999	None	3/31/08

Housing Secretary A. Jackson resigns

676999	None	3/31/08

Bush's trip to Europe

677999	None	3/31/08

Charlton Heston dies

678999	None	4/05/08

Tornadoes, storms in Texas, Arkansas, Oklahoma

679999	None	4/09/08

Pope visits U.S.

680001	Pope's relationship w/ U.S. Catholics and the state of church	4/09/08
680002	Impact of priest sex scandal	4/09/08
680003	Pope's relationship with Bush Admin and the 2008 campaign	4/09/08
680004	Substance of Pope's message	4/09/08
680006	Logistics of visit, including security	4/09/08
680007	Straight events	4/09/08
680008	Profile of Pope himself	4/09/08
680009	Relations with other religious leaders	4/09/08
680999	Other	4/09/08

Cyberspace issues

681001	Cyber Security	4/11/08
680999	Other	4/11/08

Food shortages worldwide

682999	None	4/07/08

Delta, Northwest airlines to merge

683999	None	4/15/08

Congo place crash

684999	None	4/15/08

Colorado wildfires

685999	None	4/16/08

Fresno high school student shot

686999	None	4/17/08

Illinois earthquake

687999	None	4/18/08

NY Times story about military analyst/pundits

688999	None	4/20/08

Petraeus takes over U.S. central command

689999	None	4/23/08

Syria nuclear reactor

690999 None 4/24/08
Train crash in China kills 66
691999 None 4/27/08
Austrian house w/ hostages
692999 None 4/27/08
California wildfires
693999 None 4/27/08
Virginia tornadoes
694999 None 4/29/08
Hannah Montana/ Miley Cyrus photos
69599 None 4/28/08
Arkansas, Missouri storms, on May 1
696999 None 5/01/08
Fort Bragg barracks conditions
697999 None 5/01/08
Myanmar cyclone
698999 None 5/04/08
Kentucky Derby
699001 Death of Eight Belles 5/5/08
699999 Other 5/5/08
San Diego University drug bust
700999 None 5/06/08
Philadelphia police beating controversy
701999 None 5/06/08
Israel turns 60 years old
702999 None 5/05/08
Chinese earthquake
703999 None 5/12/08
Storms in Oklahoma, Missouri over Mother's day weekend
704999 None 5/10/08
Bush trip to the Middle East
705999 None 5/12/08
Florida fires
706999 None 5/12/08
India blasts
707999 None 5/13/08
R. Kelly trial
708999 None 5/12/08
Mississippi House race
709001 Impact on presidential race 5/13/08
709999 Other 5/13/08
Robert Raischenberg, artist, dies
710999 None 5/13/08
Myspace suicide case of Lori Drew
711999 None 5/15/08
Ted Kennedy's health

712999 None 5/18/08
Farm bill in congress
713999 None 5/18/08
California wildfires near Santa Cruz
714999 None 5/22/08
Colorado tornado
715999 None 5/22/08
Sydney Pollack dies
716999 None 5/26/08
Mars Lander Phoenix
717999 None 5/26/08
Iowa, Minnesota tornadoes
718999 None 5/25/08
Scott McClellan's book about Bush
719999 None 5/28/08
Crane collapses in Manhattan
720999 None 5/30/08
Bo Diddley Dies
721999 None 6/02/08
General Motors to close four truck plants
722999 None 6/03/08
Yves Saint Laurent dies
723999 None 6/02/08
U.S. and British diplomats attacked in Zimbabwe
724999 None 6/05/08
Air Force officials resign
725999 None 6/05/08
Dow drops 400 points
726999 None 6/06/08
Texas Governor mansion fire
727999 None 6/08/08
Violent weather in Midwest and East
728999 None 6/04/08
Tokyo knife attacks
729999 None 6/08/08
Bush's last EU summit
730999 None 6/09/08
Tomatoes salmonella scare
731999 None 6/09/08
Sudan plane catches fire
732999 None 6/10/08
East Coast heat wave
733999 None 6/09/08
Boy Scout camp in Iowa hit by tornado
734999 None 6/12/08
DC power outage and fire

735999 None 6/13/08
Tim Russert dies
736999 None 6/13/08
George Carlin dies
737999 None 6/23/08
Philippine ferry capsized
738999 None 6/23/08
Kentucky plant shootings
739999 None 6/23/08
Florida buys sugar tract for Everglades
740999 None 6/23/08
California wildfires
741999 None 6/23/08
Massachusetts high school pregnancy pact
742999 None 6/25/08
DC handgun ban struck down by Supreme Court
743999 None 6/26/08
Stocks drop, hit 2 year low
744999 None 6/26/08
Dead soldier, Megan Touma, found in bathtub
745999 None 6/27/08
Helicopter crash in Arizona
746999 None 6/30/08
Missing girl in Vermont, Brooke Bennett
747999 None 7/02/08
American hostages rescued in Columbia
748999 None 7/02/08
Starbucks closing stores
749999 None 7/01/08
Jesse Helms, Senator from North Carolina, dies
750999 None 7/07/08
General Motors troubles
751999 None 7/07/08
Istanbul attack on U.S. Consulate
752999 None 7/09/08
Hurricane Bertha
753999 None 7/09/08
A-Rod’s sordid divorce
754999 None 7/10/08
Jon Benet Ramsey case developments
755999 None 7/10/08
Fannie Mae/ Freddie Mac troubles
756999 None 7/15/08
Chandra Levy developments, Washington Post story
757999 None 7/15/08
Anheuser-Busch sale to InBev

758999	None	7/15/08
Batman film release		
759999	None	7/18/08
Missing persons		
760001	Missing child (15 and under)	7/21/08
760002	Missing Young person (15 – 30s)	7/21/08
760003	Missing Military Figure	7/21/08
760999	Other	7/21/08
U.S. airline industry		
761001	Financial troubles	7/21/08
761002	Mergers	7/21/08
761003	Equipment troubles	7/21/08
761004	New regulations and policies	7/21/08
761005	Trends and Monthly travel figures, delays	7/21/08
761006	Effect of gas prices	7/21/08
761007	Minor delays	8/27/08
761999	Other	7/21/08
U.S. auto industry		
762001	Financial troubles and plant closing	7/21/08
762002	Foreign competition	7/21/08
762003	Labor issues/ Layoffs	7/21/08
762004	Effect of gas prices	7/21/08
762999	Other	7/21/08
Tropical Storm Dolly to hit Texas, Mexico		
763999	None	7/21/08
Zaradzic arrested in Belgrade		
764999	None	7/22/08
Estelle Getty dies		
765999	None	7/22/08
Caylee Anthony, missing two-year-old		
766999	None	7/24/08
Qantas jet emergency landing		
767999	None	7/28/08
Christian Bale scandal		
768999	None	7/28/08
Tennessee church shooting		
770999	None	7/29/08
Earthquake near Los Angeles		
771999	None	7/29/08
Yosemite fire		
772999	None	7/30/08
Anthrax case, suspect suicide/ settlement		
773999	None	8/04/08
Tropical Storm Edouard		
774999	None	8/04/08
Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn dies		

775999	None	8/05/08
Asia trip for Bush		
776999	None	8/05/08
K2 tragedy/ rescue		
777999	None	8/06/08
Morgan Freeman car accident		
778999	None	8/08/08
John Edwards affair		
779999	None	8/08/08
Bernie Mac dies		
780999	None	8/11/08
Clark Rockefeller kidnapping charges		
781999	None	8/11/08
Shooting at Arkansas Democratic Party HQ		
782999	None	8/13/08
Georgia/ Russia conflict		
783001	Conflict beginning August 2008	8/11/08
783999	Other	8/11/08
Tropical Storm Fay		
784999	None	8/18/08
Grand Canyon flooding		
785999	None	8/19/08
Madrid plane crash		
786999	None	8/20/08
Stephanie Tubb Jones, U.S. Representative, death		
787999	None	8/21/08
Hurricane Gustav		
788999	None	8/27/08
Google launches Chrome		
789999	None	9/02/08
Thailand protests/ unrest		
790999	None	9/02/08
India flooding		
791999	None	9/02/08
Hurricane Hanna		
792999	None	9/02/08
TV switch from analog to digital		
793999	None	9/04/08
Dick Cheney tours ex-Soviet nations		
794999	None	9/05/08
Hurricane Ike		
795001	Preparations and evacuations	9/11/08
795002	Overview, rescue efforts and death toll	9/11/08
795003	Victim stories and destruction, property loss	9/11/08
795004	Comparisons to Katrina	9/11/08
795005	Implications for other cities and lessons learnt	9/11/08

795007	Impact outside U.S.	9/11/08
795008	Effect on gas and oil	9/15/08
795999	Other	9/05/08
Bob Woodward's book, The War Within		
796999	None	9/08/08
Financial crisis/ Fed bailout		
797003	Presidential candidates' initial reactions	9/17/08
797005	Stocks market reaction	9/17/08
797007	Effects on Average Americans	9/17/08
797008	Who is to blame	9/17/08
797012	Paulson's profile and background	9/24/08
797013	FBI investigation	9/25/08
797017	Effect on other (non-banking) industries	10/01/08
797019	Finance linked suicides	10/07/08
797020	Bailout head, Kashkari, appointment	10/07/08
797021	Coordinated international interest rate cut	10/08/08
797022	Effect on state governments	10/09/08
797024	Stimulus plan and suggestions	10/20/08
797025	Housing & Financial Crisis	10/27/08
797026	Unemployment/ Jobs & Financial Crisis	10/27/08
797027	Interest Rates & Financial Crisis	10/27/08
797028	Retail Sales and Financial Crisis	10/27/08
797029	Food Prices & Financial Crisis	10/27/08
797030	Recession fears amidst Financial Crisis	10/27/08
797041	Banking related	9/17/08
797042	Federal bailout plan	9/22/08
797043	Effect on foreign economy	10/01/08
797998	Other	9/11/08
Sex for oil scandal at the Interior Department		
798999	None	9/11/08
CERN, big bang machine		
799999	None	9/11/08
Los Angeles train crash		
800999	None	9/12/08
U.S. Embassy attacked in Yemen		
801999	None	9/17/08
European tourists kidnapped in Egypt		
802999	None	9/22/08
Finland school shooting		
803999	None	9/23/08
Tropical Storm Kyle		
804999	None	9/26/08
Paul Newman dies		
805999	None	9/29/08
Bloomberg tries for third term		
806999	None	10/01/08

Fatal Los Angeles bus crash		
807999	None	10/06/08
Ukraine elections		
808999	None	10/10/08
Northern California bus crash kills 10		
809999	None	10/10/08
Southern California wildfires, beginning October 13		
810999	None	10/13/08
Nancy Reagan breaks her hip		
811999	None	10/15/08
Tim Mahoney scandal		
812999	None	10/16/08
Jennifer Hudson’s mother and brother killed		
813999	None	10/27/08
Central Arkansas University shooting		
814999	None	10/27/08
Congo civil war		
815999	None	10/29/08
State ballot initiatives for 2008		
816999	None	10/29/08
Presidential election results		
817001	Straight election results	11/05/08
817002	Candidate speeches and reactions	11/05/08
817003	Campaign analysis and postmortems	11/05/08
817004	Media coverage postmortems	11/05/08
817005	Voter turnout analysis and demographic shifts	11/05/08
817006	Racial and historical impact	11/05/08
817007	World reaction	11/05/08
817008	Future of the Republican Party	11/10/08
817999	Other	11/05/08
New Obama Administration		
818003	Relations with congress	11/05/08
818004	Cabinet decisions and top appointments	11/05/08
818005	Technical and logistical mechanics of transition	11/05/08
818006	Joe Biden's Vice Presidential role	11/05/08
818007	Michelle Obama as First Lady	11/05/08
818008	Obamas to move into White House with dog	11/05/08
818009	Inauguration event on January 20	12/08/08
818011	Domestic issues: economy	11/05/08
818012	Domestic issues: energy and environment	11/05/08
818013	Domestic issues: health care	11/05/08
818014	Domestic issues: immigration	11/05/08
818015	Domestic issues: terrorism	11/05/08
818016	Domestic issues: education	11/05/08
818017	Domestic issues: social and other issues	11/05/08
818021	Leadership and Ideology	11/05/08

818022	Foreign Issues: Iraq/ Afghanistan	11/05/08
818023	Foreign issues: Iran/ Pakistan	11/05/08
818024	Foreign Issues: other	11/05/08
818034	Foreign issues: Middle East other	11/05/08
818045	Clintons release list of foundation donors	12/18/08
818050	Reaction to Rick Warren at inauguration	12/18/08
818999	Other	11/05/08
State governments/ Gubernatorial races		
819001	Straight results	11/05/08
819002	Analysis	11/05/08
819999	Other	11/05/08
Congressional election results		
820001	Straight results	11/05/08
820002	Alaska unresolved Senate race	11/05/08
820003	Minnesota unresolved Senate race	11/05/08
820004	Georgia unresolved Senate race	11/05/08
820005	Oregon unresolved Senate race	11/05/08
820006	Unresolved House races	11/05/08
820007	Vote analysis	11/05/08
820999	Other	11/05/08
New 111th Congress		
821001	New leadership shuffle	11/05/08
821002	Joe Lieberman's role	11/05/08
821003	Caroline Kennedy/ NY seat	12/18/08
821999	Other	11/05/08
Interior Minister killed in Mexico plane crash		
822999	None	11/05/08
Michael Crichton dies		
823999	None	11/05/08
Barney bites reporter		
824999	None	11/06/08
Blizzard in the Dakotas		
825999	None	11/07/08
President Bush's last days in White House		
826999	None	11/10/08
Southern California wildfires, beginning November 10		
827999	None	11/10/08
Mexican drug war		
828999	None	11/17/08
Somali pirates		
829999	None	11/17/08
Eight-year-old boy killed father		
830999	None	11/21/08
Mukasey’s health		
831999	None	11/21/08
Mumbai terror attacks		

832999 None 11/26/08
Plaxico Burres gun case
833999 None 12/01/08
Greece riots over teen death
834999 None 12/09/08
Illinois Governor Blagojevich, Senate Seat, scandal
835001 Obama Administration, campaign staff involvement 12/10/08
835002 Tribune Co. and Blagojevich 12/10/08
835003 Jesse Jackson Jr. involvement 12/12/08
835004 Senate appointment, Roland Burris 12/30/08
835005 Possible impeachment 12/30/08
835999 Other 12/10/08
Newspaper industry troubles
836001 Tribune bankruptcy 12/10/08
836999 Other 12/10/08
San Diego Marine plane crash kills family
837999 None 12/10/08
East Coast storms
838999 None 12/10/08
Bush’s last trip to Iraq and Afghanistan
839999 None 12/15/08
Madoff banking scam
840999 None 12/16/08
Rwanda genocide mastermind convicted
841999 None 12/18/08
Deep Throat, Mark Felt dies
842999 None 12/19/08
Severe winter weather across U.S.
843999 None 12/19/08
Sherry Johnston, Bristol Palin's mother-in-law, drug charge
844999 None 12/19/08
Continental jet skids of runway in Denver
845999 None 12/22/08
Water main breaks in Maryland
846999 None 12/23/08
Santa suit gunman in California
847999 None 12/24/08
Tennessee coal ash accident
848999 None 12/24/08
Cruise ship accident of Jennifer Seitz
849999 None 12/30/08
Avalanche in British Columbia
850999 None 12/30/08
Thailand nightclub fire
852999 None 12/30/08

Midwest, Northwest nasty winter weather
853999 None 12/30/08
Harold Pinter dies
860999 None 12/25/08
Eartha Kitt dies
861999 None 12/25/08

No Big Story
999999 None 1/01/08

Notes:

- Big stories and sub-storylines dated 1/01/08 were added in 2007. For specific information, they may be found in the 2007 Data Release. http://www.journalism.org/by_the_numbers/datasets
- Some big stories may have had other sub-stories that were used in 2007 but are not listed here because they were not used in 2008.
- For any big story and sub-storyline added during the course of a given week (Monday through Sunday), relevant stories going back to the beginning of that week were reviewed and recoded.
- Some big stories and sub-storylines added on a Monday are used for data coded in the previous week. Since our data cleaning is conducted on Mondays, big stories and sub-storylines are sometimes added to reflect trends from the previous week.

GEOGRAPHIC FOCUS:

Definition: This variable concerns the geographic area to which the topic is relevant in relation to the location of the news source. If there is a mix of geographic focus, code for the geographic area that is emphasized by the MAJORITY OF TIME OR SPACE.

Local: story focuses on the metropolitan area within which the media source is published or broadcast = 0

U.S. non-local/U.S. national: story focuses on either a region outside of the media source's metropolitan area, or the nation as a whole. = 1

U.S. Intl: story refers to the U.S. in relation to some other national entity, such as a story about U.S. trade relations with Mexico. Such stories can be about non-government entities, such as sports team and tourism, for example. = 2

Non-U.S. International: Story refers to a nation outside the United States and does NOT make any explicit reference to the U.S. = 3

No Specific Geographic Focus: The story does not have a particular geographic focus or deals across all geographies. Some examples are stories about a new diet or how to improve your garden. Stories concerning global impact would be either 2 or 3 depending on the emphasis given the U.S. = 4

Don't Know/Can't Tell: = 9

BROAD STORY TOPIC

Definition: Determines the type of broad topic categories addressed by a story. The topic involves the **issue/event** being covered.

Codes:

GOVERNMENT AGENCIES/LEGISLATURES: refers to departments of government, including U.S. and state government cabinet departments, legislatures, and regulatory agencies such as the FDA or EPA. This code would include stories on executive branch/administration (White House only), national/federal legislative institutions or agencies, and state/local legislative institution or agencies including police.=1

CAMPAIGNS/ELECTIONS/POLITICS: All stories primarily about elections for government posts at local, state and national levels, or stories focused primarily on the actions of political parties. Stories on elections/campaigns/politics, election/campaign abuses and scandals, politics and religion would be coded under here. =2

DEFENSE/MILITARY (DOMESTIC): Refers to military or defense operations within the boundaries of the US such as domestic defense/military general/multi-issue/other, military operations/activities in the field within the US, and Pentagon/defense policy/budget stories. =3

COURT/LEGAL SYSTEM: Refers to the inner workings of the court system such as the appointment of judges, motions that are NOT solely about a specific crime, and other inner-workings. This code includes stories on court/legal system-mix of federal and lower (uncommon), federal Supreme Court system/internal, lower court system/internal (any court below the federal supreme court). =4

CRIME: This involves crime incidents, white collar crime/corruption, crime trends (such as statistical data on crimes or a national crime survey), crime deterrence, and trials regarding a specific crime event. Celebrity trials and scandals are excluded from this. It also DOES NOT include terrorism. =5

DOMESTIC TERRORISM: Refers to stories of U.S. terrorist events, the causes and impact or the efforts by federal, state and local police and other agencies to prevent terrorist acts. =6

BUSINESS: All non-legislative activities related to businesses, such as business and personal finance. =7

ECONOMY/ECONOMICS: Includes prices/inflation/rates, jobs/labor force, housing, stocks, taxes, and general economic information, etc. =8

ENVIRONMENT: Refers to all ecological or human-environment topics. This would include air quality, water quality, land use/ management, global warming, energy policy/alternative energy/sources/trends (but NOT gas prices), and general environmental information, etc. =9

DEVELOPMENT/SPRAWL: Refers to stories about expansion or commercial development of suburban and urban areas such as development/sprawl, and land use for disaster preparedness. =10

TRANSPORTATION: Refers to stories concerning the transportations systems, such as air travel, train travel, automobile travel, and bus travel, including transportation/general/multi-issue other, air transport, and automobile transport.
The stories DO NOT include coverage of the business side of producing automobiles and other units of transportation. =11

EDUCATION: Refers to ALL primary, secondary and post-secondary education, whether public or private. This includes non-sports extracurricular activities (debate, drama, service clubs) that are explicitly connected with schools. =12

RELIGION: Refers to worship and ideas about God, the afterlife, etc. =13

HEALTH/MEDICINE: Refers to stories on health care system, public health, diseases/prevention other, AIDS, autism, cancer, heart disease (and all related, strokes, etc), ALS, obesity/diabetes, mental health conditions, and Alzheimer's. Health care system relates to stories that are focused on the integrity of the health care system generally, such as insurance, medical training, medical care in general, etc. Public health deals with stories of pandemics, epidemics, etc. that focus on the impact of health conditions on groups of people. =14

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY: Refers to scientific research and its applications in machines, engineering, including science, technology, and technology and culture. =15

RACE/GENDER/GAY ISSUES: Refers to stories on race, gender and gay issues both as policy and domestic affairs issue. =16

IMMIGRATION: Refers to stories on immigration as both a policy and domestic affairs issue. =17

ADDITIONAL DOMESTIC AFFAIRS: Other domestic issues and trends that do not fit into above categories but impact groups of U.S. Citizens. These can be related to policy issues or to broader trends such as aging, social security, labor, welfare/poverty/homelessness, riots/civil disobedience, protests, charity/philanthropy, privacy rights, abortion, gun control, drug trafficking, and domestic affairs other (such as national remembrances and mourning). =18

DISASTERS/ACCIDENTS: Refers to stories that address any out-of-the-ordinary weather events and trends, along with stories about non-intentional events that injure, kill or cause damage including man-made disasters, natural disasters, fires commonplace, fires wide devastation, unusual weather, natural phenomena with little or no damage (such as small earthquakes). =19

CELEBRITY/ENTERTAINMENT: Stories referring to people involved in motion picture, television, stage or other entertainment venues. These stories concentrate on individuals or celebrities as an aggregate. Celebrity crime/scandal stories also would be coded under here. =20

LIFESTYLE: Stories referring to the activities and concerns of ordinary people NOT applicable to topics above. Such topics may include values, entertainment, philosophy and spiritual beliefs (other than religion), recreation (includes participation sports), etc. These can related to pets, illegal drug culture/ drug lifestyle, human interest, pop culture, travel, food/cooking, family/parenting, high arts/culture, reviews, lifestyle trends, consumer news/ products and product recalls. =21

SPORTS: Stories about professional or local sports such as college or high school athletics. This also includes sports as either a spectator or participatory event. =22

MEDIA: Stories that concentrate on what media companies and outlets are doing or have done with their NEWS coverage. =23

U.S. MISCELLANEOUS: Refers to stories about non –disastrous specific accident or mishap, parades/celebrations/festivals, how-to, obituaries, oddball news, typical weather report, typical traffic report, other, multiple topic round-up, etc. =24

U.S. FOREIGN AFFAIRS: These are stories that involve U.S. Foreign Policy or U.S. interests abroad including US foreign affairs/diplomacy (refers to stories in which 50% or more of the story is about American policy and diplomacy in relation to another country or international situation), US foreign affairs/terrorist or civilian attacks, prevention or threat of (non-military) (this refers to incidents of terrorism or combat outside the US, but does NOT include any explicit military activity), and US foreign affairs/military (any activities conducted by the United States military in a foreign country). =25

FOREIGN (NON-U.S.): This category of stories involves international events that are outside the United States in which 50% or more of the story involves events in those foreign countries rather than the American response to them including international

diplomacy, foreign science/technology, foreign sports, foreign press and media, foreign environment, etc. =26

LEAD NEWSMAKER

- **Definition**: This is the person or group that is the main focus of the story discussed with at least 50% of the story (in time or space).

Codes:

No lead newsmaker: 99

Person as lead newsmaker: last name, first name. For example: Clinton, Hillary.

MEDIA SECTOR

- Definition: This is a variable that is not coded but recoded from the variable "source" in order to help analyze data.

Codes:

Newspaper	1
Online	2
Network TV	4
Cable TV	5
Radio	8